Causal mapping: a Garden of Ideas

CHAPTERS

Articles

Some brief one-page bullet-point summaries of some of our key published papers. Enjoy.

Glossary

Some essential terminology for causal mapping.

Working Papers

This chapter is a new set of working papers about causal mapping.

Causal mapping – overview

What is causal mapping? What are its strengths and weaknesses? How does a causal map differ from a systems diagram? This chapter has some answers.

Task 1 – Gathering causal mapping data

At Causal Map we are relatively agnostic about data collection. We are most interested in causal evidence and beliefs derived from different sources.

Task 2 – Causal coding – minimalist style

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In this chapter we present some of key general principles about how to do causal mapping which we at Causal Map Ltd (and, most of the time, at BathSDR) have adopted.

Task 2 – Coding with AI

Causal coding is fascinating but can take a lot of time. Using AI to help you is pretty easy, especially if you provide a codebook of factor labels which the AI has to use, as we will explain in this chapter, when we've finished it!

Task 2 & 3 – Extensions

In the previous chapter we introduced **minimalist causal coding**:

Task 3 – Answering questions – General

The fundamental output of causal mapping is a database of causal links. If there are not too many links, this database can be visualised "as-is" in the form of a causal map or network. But usually there are too many links for this to be very useful, so we apply filters.

Task 3 – Answering questions – Individual questions

Causal mapping in evaluation

Causal mapping has been used in many different fields. In this chapter we look at how it can be applied in evaluation; its strengths and weaknesses.

Causal Mapping as QDA

Causal mapping is also a kind of Qualitative Data Analysis (QDQ). How does that even work? This chapter explains.

Causal Map app and alternatives

This guide shows how to create a simple causal map in **Kumu.io** using a spreadsheet. It includes:

AI in qualitative social science

How can we improve rigour and even reproducibility when using AI in social science? This chapter suggests some answers.

How to – in the Causal Map app

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In this chapter we look at some examples of specific workflows in causal mapping, mostly illustrated with the Causal Map app. It's work in progress, we only have a couple of pages at this point.

Qualia

Qualia is our AI interviewer.

Case studies

Here are some examples of work with Causal Map and causal mapping, and also with Qualia interviews.

For consultants

This chapter explains how individual consultants and agencies can include Causal Map and/or Qualia in their next bid.

AI and the wider world

Here are some thoughts from a couple of years ago when genAI first hit us, plus some thoughts about where we are going with it.

Finally

Licenses, how to cite Causal Map, and a bibliography.

Causal Map App

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